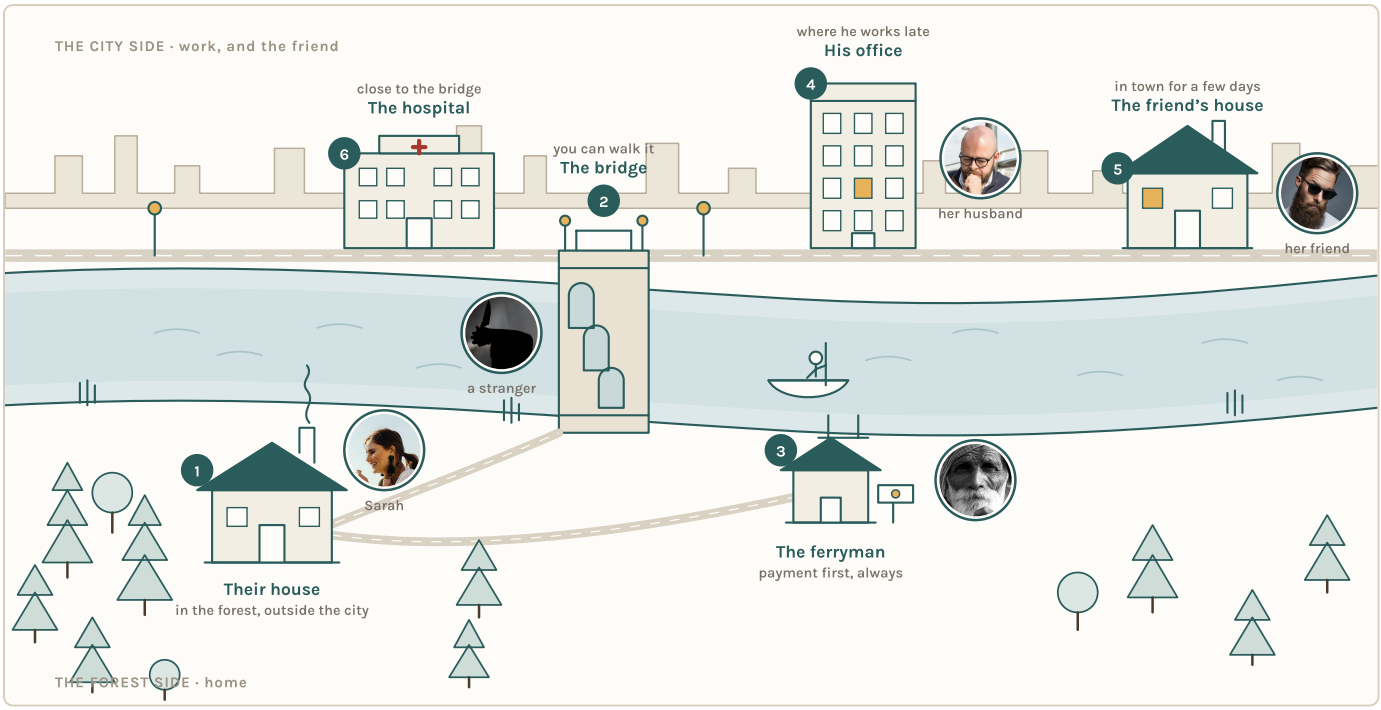
GRAMMAR · B2

The bridge story

Name _____

1 The story

Listen to the story. Look at the map as you listen.



1 Their house: in the forest, outside the city

2 The bridge: one of only two ways across

3 The ferryman: payment first, always

4 His office: where the husband works

5 The friend's house: an old friend, in town

6 The hospital: close to the bridge

2 Who is most responsible for what happened to her?

Circle one person. Then say why in one sentence.



Sarah, the wife
She left the house



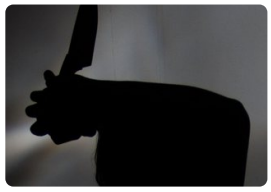
The husband
He worked through the night



The friend
He let her walk home



The ferryman
He refused to take her



The stranger
He was on the bridge

If _____

3 Check the meaning

If she had stayed at home, she would have been safe.

Circle the answer.

1. Did she stay at home? Yes / No
2. Did she leave the house? Yes / No
3. Was she safe? Yes / No

4. Are we talking about the past, now, or the future? The past | Now | The future
5. Can anyone change what happened? Yes | No
6. "She stayed at home": is that real or imaginary? Real | Imaginary

4 The form

Complete the pattern with the words in the box. One word is used twice.

had | **would** | **have** | **past participle**

If + subject + _____ + _____ , subject + _____ + _____ + _____

Now turn it around. What happens to the comma?

If she had stayed at home, she would have been safe.

She would have been safe **if she had stayed at home.**

5 Say it

Listen and repeat, from the end of the sentence back to the start.

1. safe
2. have been safe /əv bɪn 'seɪf/
3. would have been safe
4. she'd have been safe

1. home
2. at home
3. stayed at home
4. if she'd stayed at home

If she'd **STAYED** at **HOME**, she'd have been **SAFE**.

6 Match the two halves

Match each beginning to its ending. Write the letter in the box.

☐ 1 If she had stayed at home,
☐ 2 If I had had time for my wife,
☐ 3 If we hadn't bought that house,
☐ 4 If she had taken enough money,
☐ 5 If I hadn't kept filling her glass,
☐ 6 If I had taken her on my boat,
☐ 7 If I hadn't escaped from the hospital,
☐ 8 If she hadn't been so lonely,

a she would have been able to take the ferry.
b I wouldn't have had the chance to hurt her.
c she wouldn't have been hurt.
d she wouldn't have had to cross the bridge.
e I wouldn't have had to work so hard.
f would she have left the house?
g I would have gone home to have dinner with her.
h she wouldn't have left so late.

7 Finish the sentences your own way

Complete each beginning. Work with a partner first.

1. If she had found a job in the city,

2. If he hadn't worked every evening,

3. If they hadn't bought the house in the forest,

4. If she had taken some money with her,

5. If the ferryman had broken his promise,

6. If her husband had come home that night,

If you finish early, write one about yourself: *If I hadn't come to class today, ...*

8 Rank them, and argue about it

In groups, put the five people in order, from 1 (most responsible) to 5 (least). Write the number in the box. You can only defend your order with a third conditional.



Sarah, the wife
She left the house that night.

☐



The husband
He stayed at work on their anniversary.

☐



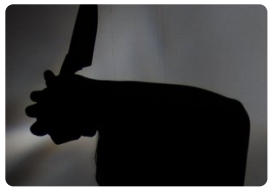
The friend
He kept filling her glass and let her walk home.

☐



The ferryman
He would not take her without payment.

☐



The stranger
He was on the bridge.

☐